

BEN YACKER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Construction Project Manager with ownership-level accountability for mission-critical infrastructure programs totaling \$4B+ in combined value. Deep technical expertise in medium-voltage utility interconnection (500kVA–2,000kVA transformer sizing, ConEd/PSEG/PECO coordination), standby power systems (generators, UPS, ATS), MEP design reviews, and energization commissioning, competencies directly applicable to data center and hyperscale facility builds. Columbia University-educated; drives results across concurrent multi-site deployments through proactive risk escalation and direct accountability for schedule, budget, and safety.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Construction Project Manager | Applegreen

April 2025 – Present

Multinational energy and convenience retail operator · 550+ locations across USA, UK & Ireland

- Own end-to-end delivery of \$200M+ in active site construction value across 80+ service areas as part of a \$1B+ Blackstone-backed capital investment program, directly accountable to ownership for schedule, budget, quality, and safety outcomes across PPP contracts with 6 state highway authorities including NY State Thruway (27 areas), NJ Turnpike Authority (21 areas), PA Turnpike Commission (17 areas), and additional state systems
- Drive medium-voltage utility interconnection process for each site, personally coordinating load studies, 500kVA–2,000kVA pad-mount transformer sizing, switchgear configurations, and service entrance upgrades with licensed electrical engineers and utility authorities (ConEd, PSEG, PECO, Delmarva Power) from interconnection application through energization
- Coordinate standby power system integration at each site, working with electrical engineers on diesel generator sizing, UPS specifications, and automatic transfer switch (ATS) configurations to ensure continuous power availability for critical charging equipment during grid outages
- Partner with licensed MEP engineers on critical power system design reviews, validating single-line diagrams, load calculations, and utility coordination documents against program specifications before field execution
- Oversee energization acceptance testing and commissioning for each installation, coordinating between EV charging equipment vendors, electrical contractors, and utility authorities to validate service entrance performance, charging station functionality, and grid stability prior to site turnover
- Manage design-build delivery across multiple PPP contract sites under a Blackstone Infrastructure Partners-backed investment structure, coordinating integrated design and construction phases, reviewing design submittals for constructability, and managing design-build trade contractors accountable for both engineering and field execution
- Drive 30+ subcontractors to program deadlines across concurrent active sites; own RFP coordination, bid evaluation, and scope negotiation for all multi-state trade contracts, accountable for award decisions aligned with program budget and timeline
- Own end-to-end permitting outcomes across municipal, utility, electrical, and inspection domains in multiple state jurisdictions, maintaining zero permit-related schedule delays through proactive agency coordination and early application strategy
- Advance state clean energy mandates through each PPP contract, directly supporting 100% EV coverage commitments on NY and NJ state highway systems and contributing to carbon reduction goals aligned with the NY Climate Leadership and Community Protection Act and NJ Clean Energy Program targets
- Serve as sole owner's representative in all government agency, state authority, and PPP compliance interactions

Project Coordinator | FRAM+Slokker

2023 – 2025

Award-winning mixed-use developer · Brightwater is one of North America's landmark master-planned communities

- Served as primary execution lead for senior PM across all active phases of a ~\$3B USD master-planned waterfront development on a remediated former industrial site, with direct accountability for subcontractor performance, RFI resolution, budget tracking, and permitting outcomes
- Owned accountability for \$150M+ in phase-dedicated construction budgets across concurrent active phases; collaborated with development and finance teams on monthly budget reconciliation, tracking construction costs against the pro forma and providing cost analysis for ownership and investor reporting

- Prepared and delivered monthly construction progress reports to the owner and investment committee, providing schedule status, risk assessments, and recovery plan recommendations that informed project-level development decisions
- Drove owner design review process across SD, DD, and CD phases, coordinating architect and MEP consultant responses to owner comments, tracking design changes against budget and constructability requirements, and ensuring procurement-ready documents on schedule
- Coordinated environmental compliance for development on a remediated former industrial waterfront site, overseeing stormwater controls, erosion and sediment measures, and regulatory reporting; oversaw delivery of 18+ acres of public park and open space integrated into the master plan
- Took direct ownership of subcontractor safety compliance through weekly toolbox talks, safety plan reviews, and site audit protocols, maintaining zero lost-time incidents across all active phases
- Drove subcontractor procurement across 25+ active trade contracts spanning structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, envelope, and finishing scopes; managed 25+ subcontractors simultaneously from mobilization through final turnover
- Managed change order process on behalf of the owner, evaluating GC proposals for merit, negotiating scope and pricing, and tracking approved changes against phase budgets; identified constructability conflicts during design reviews that reduced post-construction change exposure
- Processed 400+ RFIs and submittals; led full permitting portfolio including municipal/zoning, building permits, environmental assessments, utility coordination, and occupancy inspections with zero delays across any phase

EDUCATION

Post-Graduate Certificate, Construction Project Management | *Columbia University*
Engineering Division

Graduate Certificate, Construction Management | *George Brown College*
Angelo DelZotto School of Construction Management

Undergraduate Degree, Building Technology | *George Brown College*

CERTIFICATIONS

OSHA 30-Hour Construction Safety Certification

TECHNICAL SKILLS & CORE COMPETENCIES

Electrical Infrastructure: Medium-voltage interconnection, load studies, transformer sizing (500kVA–2,000kVA), ATS, UPS, generator specifications, energization commissioning

Program Management: Multi-site concurrent delivery, PPP contract management, design-build coordination, owner's representation, MEP design reviews

Construction Management: Multi-trade coordination, RFI/submittal management, budget & schedule control, subcontractor procurement, change order management

Permitting & Regulatory: Municipal/zoning, building permits, environmental assessments, utility coordination, multi-state regulatory compliance

Software: Procore, MS Project, Primavera P6, Bluebeam, AutoCAD (reading), BIM/Revit (reading), MS Office Suite